

Smart guns matter

A look at the interesting new tech behind smart guns and why they're increasingly inevitable: <http://dgit.in/1oo1Nun>



Hacker Army

Here's a sneak peak at China's infamous "Hacker Army": <http://dgit.in/1jNh3l4>

Agent 001

Much hardship

I want to buy a hard drive around ₹6,000 please help to choose the best one. I want more around the price it should have usb 3.0 and backup compatibility and space 1 TB or more I'm ready to buy from Flipkart or Amazon but help me to choose one the best one. Thank you.

—Bibek Dekka

A You haven't mentioned whether you want a portable or a plain external. Anyways, according to your budget you do have plenty of options. And when you say "best" there are a lot of features that come into play. If you want transfer speeds then there is the Seagate Backup Plus Fast which we've covered in the Bazaar section this month, but it's way out of your budget. Then, if you want a rugged drive that can take quite a beating (only when not powered) then you can check out ADATA's HD710 Dash Drive or Transcend's StoreJet 25M3. If you wish for



Motherboard madness

more capacity then for about ₹6,300 you can get WD Elements Portable 2TB which even has a backup software pre-loaded, as is the case with most external drives. You can always look towards other free software to take backups and not necessarily depend upon what the manufacturer gives you. There are plenty of such software available including CloneZilla, Easeus, Macrium Reflect etc., All the drives we've mentioned have USB 3.0 so you can take your pick.

Too many choices

Hey Digit, I am considering the rig that you all have provided last month on your website. <http://dgit.in/50KGaming>

I am just thinking about doing a minor change. Can i change the motherboard to ASUS M5A97 LE?? I have read reviews that it has compatibility issues with the fx 8320 and I have also heard that MSI's after sale service is not that good.

So, am I making the right decision??

Can i also go for the dell S2240L?? Or should I stick with your suggestions?

Anyways i don't know if you will reply this time but I am still very much grateful of you guys for posting that article. Hoping to get a reply from you soon.

—Hrshikeshdas Das

A You can choose whichever motherboard you wish to have as long as the CPU is supported by the board. The motherboard manufacturer will list out all the CPUs that are compatible with the said board. About this problem that you've read about, there can be plenty of issues but not all of them are linked directly to the motherboard.

However, we haven't tested this particular board so we can't really comment on the same. But by all means, you can pick any compatible board. As for the monitor, yes, the Dell S2240L is a good monitor as well. The difference is that the Dell has a glass panel in the front of the screen while the LG's screen has a matte finish. Whether you're fine with a glossy panel or not will determine your choice. Moreover, the LG monitor has a DVI connector while the Dell monitor doesn't, and that's more important. Lastly, the LG Monitor is cheaper than the Dell and we picked it since it allowed us to improve other hardware in the build. In the end however, the choice is still yours.

Old is not always gold

My computer has become obsolete so I would like to upgrade it. So I need not provide computer specs. I want a motherboard(probably of intel with 3 RAM slots), 1GB DDR3 SDRAM(4 to 8GB as I already have a 2GB RAM-probably corsair). For these two my budget is ₹8,000 to ₹11,000. Can I insert a 2GB and 4GB RAM simultaneously

on same motherboard, both DDR3 and can I remove the processor from old motherboard and insert in the new one.If not then please suggest one. Thank you.

—Anany Prakhara

A You should provide the computer specifications since there are plenty of parameters which we look at before answering your queries. In this very query you've asked us if you can use your old processor. The answer is both yes and no. If you were to buy a new motherboard



Your monitor should have plenty of connectivity options

with the same chipset as before then yes. If you were to buy a motherboard with a different chipset then no. Since you haven't mentioned the chipset you're using and with no mention of the CPU, we can't suggest components without making a few assumptions which may be windily inaccurate in these circumstances.

As for your query regarding mixing two modules of different capacities, yes, you can do so but the RAM with the higher frequency will be downclocked to match the lower frequency of the other module, if at all this is the scenario. You do find motherboards with three slots, but very few allow for such a configuration. Native triple channel support existed on the X58 chipset which has now hit it's EOL. Other boards in your budget will come with 4 RAM slots. Two of the modules will run in dual channel mode while one will function in single channel mode. There is the possibility of compatibility issues as well. We do apologise if the answer seems a bit vague, but please do take the trouble to post details about your hardware as we need all the information we can get.